Barents shelf off northern Europe and Alaska north of the Brooks Range.

53. In Canada the Cordilleras consist of six well-marked zones: (1) the 10,000 to 12,000 foot (3000- to 3700- metre) high Rocky Mountains, continuing north into the Brooks Range of Alaska, (2) the Rocky Mountain Trench, a profound fault feature forming the headwaters of the Columbia, Fraser, Peace, and Yukon rivers, (3) the interior uplands and old fold mountains from the Selkirk and Okanogan ranges in the south to the Cassiar Mountains and the Yukon Plateau in the north, mostly lying at elevations of about 2400 feet (700 metres) but with ridges above 8000 feet (2400 metres), (4) the Coast Mountains, extending north into the Alaska Range and including lofty volcanoes in the north, (5) the Inside Passage from Puget Sound to Alaska, which is possibly a downfaulted zone flooded by the sea, and (6) a structurally complex outer island arc, running from Vancouver Island to the Aleutian Islands. The magnificent scenery of the northern Rocky Mountains, including U-shaped valleys often extending westward into sea-drowned fjords, has resulted from frequent glaciation, and some areas still nurse sizable glaciers.